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‘We learned the true meaning of resilience
when one of our classmates was faced with injustice.’

YAGO SAMPAIO, *Milford High School class president*



JESSICA RINALDI/GLOBE STAFF

Edison Sinchi Taïpe (above, at home, and below, at graduation) was detained for five days after a traffic stop.

ON VERGE OF GRADUATION, THEY GET NO BREAK FROM ICE

As arrests continue, students find support from classmates and schools

By Marcela Rodrigues
GLOBE STAFF

FRAMINGHAM — Nine days before graduation, Edison Sinchi Taïpe traveled to New Hampshire to work as a roofer so he could buy a dress for his mother to wear to the Framingham High School ceremony.

Before receiving his diploma, however, the 19-year-old from Ecuador joined a growing number of young immigrants whose path to commencement has led through a federal detention facility.

Sinchi Taïpe was arrested during a traffic stop on his way home from roofing that day and, an immigration judge would later rule, was “unlawfully detained” for five days. Framingham rallied successfully for his release just before graduation, with high school administrator Jacob Hanson writing a letter asking the court to release Sinchi Taïpe in time for the ceremony.



“This is an important milestone that he has dedicated significant time and effort toward achieving,” wrote Hanson, an administrator at Framingham’s Thayer Campus. “Our staff cares deeply about Edison and values the role he plays in our school community.”

This commencement season, an untold number of graduating seniors have endured exceptional challenges because of an ongoing crackdown by US Immigration and Customs Enforcement. Arrests have continued in New England and across the country as the agency has targeted immigrants like Sinchi Taïpe without criminal records.

From Chicago to Austin, Texas, federal agents have arrested students and soon-to-be graduates at immigration appointments and on their way home from work. In Los Angeles, an aspiring doctor was taken into custody the day after receiving his diploma.

ICE, Page A7

Mass. Senate takes a crack at energy bills

By Kate Selig
and Sabrina Shankman
GLOBE STAFF

With voters increasingly squeezed by high prices at gas stations, grocery stores, and doctors’ offices, Democrats on Beacon Hill are zeroing in on a series of major changes to ease another prominent pain point: soaring utility bills.

The latest development came Wednesday when leaders of the Senate released an energy affordability bill, following one from Governor Maura Healey and a separate version

passed by the House of Representatives in February.

Though the target may be the same — high bills — the approaches by the three sides differ. Unlike the House, the Senate would preserve the embattled Mass Save program, which is the state’s primary tool for energy efficiency measures that help homeowners transition from fossil fuels but comes with hefty costs borne by ratepayers.

Instead, Senate lawmakers would recoup costs for residents by taking a harder line on natural gas and elec-

tric utilities. It would make it easier for regulators to limit rate increases that guarantee utilities a profit on their investments in large capital projects. Instead, utilities would be encouraged to borrow more through special bonds for those projects, or conversely, reconsider whether they are worth doing.

Healey made a similar proposal in her legislation, and if adopted, it would be a significant change to how utilities are regulated. Senate leaders said theirs would result in as much as

ENERGY, Page A10

Trump won’t sign bipartisan accord

Catching allies off guard, he demands election act in exchange for housing bill

By Tal Kopan, Jim Puzzanghera,
and Jackie Kucinich

GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — It was all going so well.

The American flags were in place. The red-carpeted stage was set with a lectern bearing the presidential seal. The social media posts from the top White House communicators hailing the achievement were up. And the chairs in the Capitol’s grand Statuary Hall bore placards for the key lawmakers ready to celebrate a rare bipartisan achievement.

Then, less than two hours before the scheduled signing ceremony Wednesday for significant housing affordability legislation, President Trump pulled the plug.

Trump abruptly announced he would not sign the 21st Century Road to Housing Act championed by Massachusetts Senator Elizabeth Warren after all, despite it passing by huge bipartisan margins in both chambers of Congress this week. Instead, Trump insisted he would only approve the heavily negotiated bill if Congress also sent him the SAVE America Act — a controversial election overhaul bill backed mostly by Republicans that has no realistic path to becoming law.

Hours later, even after a closed-door meeting

HOUSING, Page A6

Campbell feels heat over disqualified ballot questions

By Chris Van Buskirk

GLOBE STAFF

When a record number of ballot proposals crossed her desk last year, Attorney General Andrea Campbell promised a “thorough review” of each one and commended the burst of citizen-led democracy.

“I applaud the civic engagement of our residents,” she said.

But that deluge has since turned into a legal and political headache, especially for Campbell. The attorney general this week acknowledged her office got a series of ballot questions “wrong” — leading to two being struck down by the state’s highest court in the space of a week — but argued that “no one should expect us to get a perfect result.”

The Supreme Judicial Court’s rulings drastically altered the landscape of this year’s election, where advocates and opponents were gearing up for what were expected to be costly fights over a proposal to slash the state income tax and another to create one of the strictest rent control policies in the country.

The rulings also put a spotlight on Campbell’s office’s handling of the ballot questions through

CAMPBELL, Page A6

Boston is still experiencing the driest year on record despite the soaking rain earlier this week. **B1.**

Roughly 350,000 jobs in the Boston area are vulnerable to AI. Check out the charts showing which ones are most exposed. **D1.**

The Israeli military said thousands of its troops have surrounded an underground Hezbollah fortress beneath the hills of Lebanon. **A3.**

The Red Sox lost another stunner to the lowly Rockies, this time because of a bullpen collapse. **C1.**

Drive-in range
Thursday: A few clouds.
High 80-85. Low 62-67.
Friday: Early showers.
High 78-83. Low 64-69.
Sunrise: 5:08 Sunset: 8:25
Weather and Comics, D5-6.

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For Cambridge bars and restaurants, it’s no time for a liquor crackdown

Board wants tighter rules — how about 30 minutes between drinks?

By Alexa Gagosz
GLOBE STAFF

It was just a few days ago that the partying mood in Cambridge was high, after the city allowed World Cup fans to stroll in public with a cocktail in hand, a move that finally suggested a more laissez-faire attitude in a state known for its restrictions on alcohol.

Now for the buzzkill.

Cambridge regulators are considering an overhaul of the city’s liquor laws that swing in the opposite direction, tightening the rules so much that restaurant and bar owners warn they could be strangled by the most restrictive drinking codes in the country.

The proposed regulations drew little public attention until Lauren Friel, owner of local wine bar Dear Annie, posted an Instagram video walking viewers through a 30-page proposal that would even limit customers to a single drink every half-hour.

The proposed laws “are really restrictive,” said Friel in the video, which has since been shared more than 2,500 times. “They would probably be the most restrictive in the country.”

Within days, restaurant and bar owners flooded Cambridge officials with their objections, city councilors distanced themselves from the proposal, and what had been a

CAMBRIDGE, Page A7

